

MEP Roll-Up Report

Tracking private equity, consolidation, and operational strategy across the MEP contractor market.

ISSUE No. 1 • June 2026	COVERAGE U.S. Commercial MEP	TRACKER WINDOW Jan 2025 – Jun 2026	AS OF June 22, 2026
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THE REPORT

Four sections, one topic each — formatted for distribution via the Runding MEP Roll-Up Report on LinkedIn.

01 **MEP PE DEAL ACTIVITY**

Truelink Capital forms a mission-critical MEP platform with Horwitz

In June, Los Angeles-based Truelink Capital made a significant investment in Horwitz, a 1918-founded Minneapolis provider of mechanical, electrical, plumbing, and building-automation services with roughly 720 employees, including 540 technicians. The deal establishes Horwitz as a regional platform serving high-growth, mission-critical end markets — data centers, semiconductor fabrication, medtech, and healthcare — anchored by a recurring service-and-maintenance base. For Truelink, this is a platform formation rather than a bolt-on: a foundation for consolidating adjacent MEP capabilities across the Upper Midwest. The transaction reflects a broader pattern in commercial MEP, where sponsors increasingly favor multi-trade contractors able to self-perform across disciplines on complex facilities rather than single-trade specialists.

02 **MARKET / STRATEGY INSIGHT**

Commercial MEP is still early in its consolidation cycle

While residential HVAC consolidation is widely viewed as roughly midway through its cycle, commercial MEP services remain in the early innings, according to PKF Investment Banking — a gap that helps explain where sponsor attention is shifting. Commercial platforms command premium multiples to residential roll-ups, supported by recurring maintenance revenue, multi-trade bundling, and exposure to data-center and mission-critical demand. Deal volume cooled in early 2026 — R.L. Hulett tracked a 21.7% sequential decline in Q1 MEP transactions amid higher project costs and labor constraints — yet private equity's share of that volume reached a four-year high, underscoring sustained sponsor appetite. The pattern points to a longer runway for commercial MEP consolidation than headline volume alone suggests.

PE's playbook shifts from financial engineering to operational execution

In FMI's latest "Inside FMI" Q&A, financial-sponsor-coverage lead Jayson Post argues that private equity's value-creation model in the built environment is changing: with multiple expansion and financial engineering harder to rely on, returns increasingly hinge on operational execution, fueling more operator-led strategies. He points to the electrical value chain — from power generation through in-facility electrical infrastructure — as the most active investment area, driven by electrification, AI-led data-center demand, and aging systems. Post notes that platform buyers prize market tailwinds, durable revenue, and fragmentation suited to buy-and-build — but cautions that acquirers at exit now expect demonstrated M&A integration, not merely deal count. Capital, he expects, will keep concentrating in the lower-middle market.

AiRCO Mechanical — building the operational foundation for scale

AiRCO Mechanical, a Central Texas HVAC, electrical, and plumbing contractor, has partnered with Runding to strengthen its operational foundation during a period of rapid growth. As volume scaled, AiRCO encountered familiar specialty-contractor pressure points: limited visibility into operational performance, harder capacity planning, and tighter margin protection across an expanding project portfolio. The engagement deploys OpenBuild to centralize project tracking, improve financial visibility, and structure workflows around AiRCO's existing project lifecycle — augmenting current systems rather than replacing them, so field teams retain the flexibility they depend on. The engagement reflects a recurring reality in MEP consolidation: rapid growth exposes the gap between field execution and financial control, and durable scale rests on the project-controls infrastructure that protects margin.

THE DATA • SUPPORTING DEAL INTELLIGENCE

The living dataset behind the report: U.S. commercial MEP contractor transactions with private-equity involvement, January 2025 to date.

A M&A / Market Activity

Every row is a PE-backed or sponsor-involved transaction among U.S. commercial MEP contractors. Employee counts appear only where a credible source states them explicitly; a dash means undisclosed.

DATE	ACQUIRER / SPONSOR	TARGET	SUBSECTOR	EMP.	TYPE	SOURCE
Jun 15, 2026	Truelink Capital	Horwitz	● HVAC / Elec / Plumbing	~720	Platform	PR Newswire
May 4, 2026	Prime Electric (Truelink)	Scholes Electric	● Electrical	—	Add-on	PR Newswire
Jan 29, 2026	Ares Mgmt · EIP · IPS	Techpro Power Group	● Electrical	—	Platform	PitchBook / R.L. Hulett
Jan 13, 2026	Astra Service Partners (Alpine)	CMC Corporate Solutions	● HVAC / Mechanical	—	Add-on	Astra Service Partners
Jan 7, 2026	Blackstone (BXPE)	AIR Control Concepts	● HVAC / Electrical	~1,900	Recap	Blackstone

DATE	ACQUIRER / SPONSOR	TARGET	SUBSECTOR	EMP.	TYPE	SOURCE
Jan 2, 2026	Legence (Blackstone)	Bowers	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	PitchBook / R.L. Hulett
Dec 2025	Bain Capital · Mubadala	Service Logic	● HVAC / Mechanical	—	Recap	PE Hub / CT Acquisitions
Dec 18, 2025	Modigent	Southland Mechanical	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	PR Newswire
Dec 2025	Investcorp	Guardian Fire Services	● Fire & Life Safety	—	Recap	Investcorp
Nov 12, 2025	Percheron Capital	ASPYRE Fire & Life Safety	● Fire & Life Safety	—	Platform	Percheron Capital
Nov 5, 2025	Norlee Group (Heartwood)	Inter-Bay Electric	● Electrical	—	Add-on	PrivSource
Oct 1, 2025	Comfort Systems USA	Feyen Zylstra · Meisner Electric	● Electrical	—	Add-on	SEC 10-K
Sep 22, 2025	Astra Service Partners (Alpine)	Knott Mechanical	● HVAC / Mechanical	—	Add-on	Business Wire
Jul 15, 2025	Modigent	VMG Mechanical	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	PR Newswire
May 20, 2025	Pinnacle MEP (Blue Point)	Hamman Electric	● Electrical	—	Add-on	Blue Point Capital
May 2025	Alaris Equity Partners	Professional Electrical Contractors of CT	● Electrical	300	Platform	Hartford Business Jnl
May 1, 2025	Paramount Mechanical (Stonebridge)	Comfort Solutions of Tidewater	● HVAC / Mechanical	—	Add-on	PrivSource
May 1, 2025	Comfort Systems USA	Right Way Plumbing & Mechanical	● Plumbing / Mechanical	—	Add-on	SEC 10-K
Feb 26, 2025	Agellus Capital	Bluejack Fire & Life Safety	● Fire & Life Safety	—	Platform	Business Wire
Jan 1, 2025	Comfort Systems USA	Century Contractors	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	SEC 10-K
2025	ENFRA (fmr. Bernhard)	River Mechanical Services	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	PrivSource
2025	Grizzly MEP (Garnett Station)	Vermont Mechanical	● Mechanical	—	Add-on	PrivSource

B Newsletter Snapshot — 10 Deals

A skimmable cross-section, recent-weighted and balanced across subsectors and buyers.

#	ACQUIRER / SPONSOR	TARGET	SUBSECTOR	TYPE	EMP.
1	Truelink Capital	Horwitz	● HVAC / Elec / Plumbing	Platform	~720
2	Blackstone (BXPE)	AIR Control Concepts	● HVAC / Electrical	Recap	~1,900

#	ACQUIRER / SPONSOR	TARGET	SUBSECTOR	TYPE	EMP.
3	Ares Management	Techpro Power Group	● Electrical	Platform	—
4	Bain Capital · Mubadala	Service Logic	● HVAC / Mechanical	Recap	—
5	Astra Service Partners	CMC Corporate Solutions	● HVAC / Mechanical	Add-on	—
6	Investcorp	Guardian Fire Services	● Fire & Life Safety	Recap	—
7	Percheron Capital	ASPYPE Fire & Life Safety	● Fire & Life Safety	Platform	—
8	Prime Electric (Truelink)	Scholes Electric	● Electrical	Add-on	—
9	Alaris Equity Partners	Professional Electrical Contractors of CT	● Electrical	Platform	300
10	Legence (Blackstone)	Bowers	● Mechanical	Add-on	—

C Signal Over Volume — 5 Deals

The transactions that best read where the commercial MEP roll-up market is heading.

1 Blackstone → AIR Control Concepts

● HVAC / Electrical | Recapitalization | ~1,900 emp.

Blackstone bought out Madison Dearborn to become sole institutional owner of the largest commercial HVAC, electrical, and controls platform in North America — and parked it in BXPE, its perpetual-capital vehicle, signaling a long hold. The clearest sign yet that mega-cap capital treats commercial MEP, with its data-center and mission-critical exposure, as a core consolidation theme rather than an adjacency.

2 Truelink Capital → Horwitz

● HVAC / Electrical / Plumbing | Platform formation | ~720 emp.

Truelink formed a platform around a 1918-founded, mission-critical multi-trade MEP provider serving data centers, semiconductor fabs, and healthcare. It is a clean expression of the convergence thesis: sponsors increasingly want one platform that can self-perform across all the MEP trades on high-complexity facilities.

3 Bain Capital · Mubadala → Service Logic

● HVAC / Mechanical | Recap

Bain Capital and Abu Dhabi's Mubadala took control of Service Logic — widely cited as the largest commercial mechanical services platform — from Leonard Green. Sovereign capital entering U.S. commercial MEP at this scale underscores how much runway sponsors see in a commercial services cycle still in its early innings.

4 Ares Management → Techpro Power Group

● Electrical · Power | Buyout / Platform · ~\$350M

Ares, with Energy Impact Partners and Integrated Power Services, backed a ~\$350M buyout of an electrical testing and commissioning provider for power and industrial systems. Power reliability is the gating constraint on the data-center build-out, which turns commissioning capacity into a strategically scarce asset rather than a commodity trade.

5 Legence → Bowers

● Mechanical | Add-on · ~\$475M

Legence, the Blackstone-backed energy-services and mechanical platform, opened the year with a ~\$475M add-on of Bowers, a mechanical contractor serving commercial and institutional facilities. It shows scaled platforms continuing capability-deepening M&A; even as headline volume softened, and the convergence of mechanical contracting with energy-performance services.

Scope & method. The tracker covers U.S. HVAC, mechanical, plumbing, electrical, and fire & life safety **contractors** with private-equity involvement (platform, add-on, or recap), dated January 1, 2025 – June 22, 2026, **commercial end markets only**. Pure component manufacturers, distributors, and building-automation product makers are out of scope this cycle. **Employee counts** are shown only where explicitly stated by a credible source — never estimated; a dash (—) means undisclosed.

Sources: PR Newswire / Business Wire; PE Hub; ACHR News; Middle Market Growth (ACG); CT Acquisitions MEP PE Roll-Up Tracker; regional business journals; SEC 10-K filings (Comfort Systems USA); PitchBook via R.L. Hulett *MEP Services M&A Update Q1 2026*; PKF Investment Banking; Capstone Partners; FMI Corporation (*Inside FMI*, Jayson Post, May 2026); Runding case study (AiRCO Mechanical); Blackstone; Investcorp; Percheron Capital; Blue Point Capital; Astra Service Partners; PrivSource.